

THE BOND WITH A TRUE DOG IS AS LASTING AS THE TIES OF THIS EARTH CAN EVER BE

ANIMAL BEHAVIOR

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURES

Konrad Lorenz (1903–89), **Nikolaas Tinbergen** (1907–88)

BEFORE

1872 Charles Darwin's *The Expression of the Emotions in Man and Animals* posits that behavior is instinctive and has a genetic basis.

1951 Nikolaas Tinbergen's *The Study of Instinct* lays down the foundations and theory behind ethology, the study of animal behavior.

AFTER

1967 Desmond Morris, a British zoologist, brings ethology to bear on human behavior in his popular book *The Naked Ape*.

1976 British evolutionary biologist Richard Dawkins publishes *The Selfish Gene*, describing how most of an animal's behavior is designed to pass on its genes.

Any dog owner will describe the companionable and loyal relationship they enjoy with their pet. The Austrian zoologist Konrad Lorenz set out to explain this behavior in *Man Meets Dog* (1949). He described the behavior of dogs and other pets as substantially innate, "instinctive activity," as opposed to behavior learned through conditioning. Lorenz proposed that